

Chapter 33 Part 5

Xu Qingzhu smiled wryly but still put on a stern face and said, "Then let me ask you, do you still remember why you originally wanted to marry me?"

Liang Shi: "...I don't remember."

"Do you still remember what you did on our wedding night?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Her expression changed slightly.

She didn't have memories of that night, but she knew what the original had done that night.

She went to sleep with another woman.

"No lying." Xu Qingzhu reminded her.

Liang Shi closed her eyes and finally chose to be honest, "I roughly know."

Xu Qingzhu frowned, "What do you mean?"

"You mentioned it when you were drunk last time." Liang Shi brought it up somewhat embarrassedly, "Anyway, it was a very bastardly thing to do."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"Do you still remember being kidnapped when you were seven?" Xu Qingzhu stared at her intently, observing her every expression.

Liang Shi was confused. She shook her head, "I don't remember."

"Then what's your catchphrase?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi: "...Eat well?"

Xu Qingzhu's expression cracked for a moment.

She made a last-ditch effort, saying expressionlessly, "Life will definitely get better, because we will surely have lots of love. Do you often say this too?"

Liang Shi nodded, "Occasionally."

Xu Qingzhu asked, "Why do you say it?"

Liang Shi: "...Just to encourage myself, I guess. Sometimes I feel like life is difficult, so I tell myself some things to help myself reconcile with the world."

Even though it was somewhat difficult to answer, Liang Shi still chose the most concise words and most appropriate language to explain to her.

"Besides, there's this line in a movie." Liang Shi said, "《Lonely Island》¹. I occasionally think of this phrase after watching this movie."

"How old were you when you watched this movie?" Xu Qingzhu asked again.

Liang Shi: "Ten years old."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She suddenly showed a weary smile, making Liang Shi feel at a loss, "What's wrong? Is there something wrong with that phrase?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu said, "I was mistaken."

She pressed her lips together, her tone unable to hide her disappointment, "Sorry, you go ahead with your work. I'll go to the study."

"You haven't told me yet." Liang Shi asked her retreating figure, "What exactly happened between us last night?"

Xu Qingzhu stopped in her tracks, turned back with a smile, "You bit my finger."

Liang Shi: "?"

"You almost ate my fingernail." Xu Qingzhu said, "Sister, promise me, if you can't drink, don't brag, okay?"

Liang Shi: "...I didn't."

"Okay, got it." Xu Qingzhu waved her finger that had been trimmed bare, "Thanks to you, I'm planning to get a manicure today."

Liang Shi: "...Okay."

After Xu Qingzhu left the kitchen, Liang Shi knocked her head against the wall and began to regret drinking last night.

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The study was bathed in sunlight—today was another rare sunny day in Hazhou City.

After Xu Qingzhu closed the study door, she leaned against it to rest. She had asked each of those questions with trepidation.

Afraid it was her, yet afraid it wasn't her.

But in the end, she couldn't verify anything.

The latter possibility even seemed more likely.

She stayed in the study and watched the movie 《Lonely Island》 that Liang Shi had mentioned. It told the story of a goddess's daughter and a mermaid.

The mermaid never believed in gods, while the goddess's daughter initially didn't know her true identity and lived as a tragic human being with no family, no friends, wearing tattered clothes all day and going hungry.

But she was always optimistic and strong. She would say: Life will definitely get better, because we will have lots of love.

Yet her reality was that everyone despised her, no one liked her, and no one loved her.

Even when life was a complete mess, she still believed this firmly.

At the end of the film, she said: I've always believed in gods because if I didn't believe this way, I couldn't survive.

——Later I discovered that there really are gods in this world, and she will return the love I've lost to me.

It was quite a tear-jerking film.

Xu Qingzhu was someone who couldn't easily get emotionally invested when watching movies. As someone in a film and TV drought, she usually only watched highly-rated productions, and very few could make her cry. Even when the comments were already scrolling: "Tears streaming down like a river, crying so hard my hands are shaking."

She still had no reaction.

She had once watched a tear-jerker with Xu Qingya. Xu Qingya cried with snot and tears while she remained unmoved.

Xu Qingya said she was cold-blooded.

But this time, probably because it overlapped with her past memories, she couldn't stop crying halfway through the movie.

She almost integrated all her childhood memories into it.

By the time Liang Shi knocked on the door to call her for dinner, her eyes were still red.

When she opened the door, she startled Liang Shi, "What's wrong? It wasn't me who upset you, was it?"

Please, please let it not be.

Otherwise, the system would add misfortune points to her.

Xu Qingzhu said expressionlessly, "No, but it has something to do with you."

Liang Shi's heart immediately jumped to her throat.

"I watched the movie you mentioned earlier." Xu Qingzhu added.

Only then did Liang Shi relax, "I haven't rewatched it in a long time. That film is godlike in my heart."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her, "Since when have you become so interested in movies?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She was silent for a long time, then used a phrase Xu Qingzhu had once said to retort, "Maybe you haven't really understood me either."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

Footnotes: ¹ 《孤島》 (Lonely Island) - This appears to be a fictional movie within the novel's universe that serves as a parallel to the main character's experiences.